Rory Harder

roryharder@gmail.com & www.roryharder.com

AOS Philosophy of Mind, Philosophy of Language
AOC Epistemology, Logic, History of Philosophy (early analytic, early modern)

Employment

2025–2027 Postdoctoral Fellow, Collège de France
Project: Mental Files: New Foundations, *Principal Investigator:* François Recanati
2023–2025 Postdoctoral Fellow, University College Dublin
Project: Institution and Conversation, *Principal Investigator:* Elmar Unnsteinsson
2022–2023 Assistant Professor (part-time, teaching stream), University of Toronto
2019–2020 Sessional Lecturer, Rutgers University

Education

2015–2022 PhD in Philosophy, University of Toronto
Dissertation Title: Joint Action and Communication, with a Focus on Demonstratives
Committee: Imogen Dickie (co-supervisor), Nate Charlow (co-supervisor), Phil Kremer, David Barnett (internal examiner), Guy Longworth (external examiner)
2019 Visiting Student in Linguistics, Rutgers University, *Host Supervisor:* Simon Charlow
2011–2015 BA (Hons) with High Distinction in Philosophy (Specialist) and History and Philosophy of Science and Technology (Minor), University of Toronto

Papers

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

2025 Knowledge-First Mentalizing: Concept-Based or Merely State-Based?
Synthese, https://doi.org/10.1007/s11229-025-05213-1
2023 Clearing up Clouds: Underspecification in Demonstrative Communication
Canadian Journal of Philosophy, https://doi.org/10.1017/can.2023.26
2022 Joint Attention and Communication
Inquiry, https://10.1080/0020174X.2022.2074101

Public Philosophy

2025 Nietzsche on Justice
Washington University Review of Philosophy, https://doi.org/10.5840/wurop2025410

In Progress

[A paper on the metasemantics of demonstratives], *Under Review*
[A paper on the formal semantics of demonstratives], *Under Review*
[A paper on the formal semantics of deictic features], *Under Review*
[A paper on speech acts], *Manuscript in Preparation*
[A paper on copredication], *Manuscript in Preparation*

Presentations

2026 Demonstratives Contribute Conventional Implicatures, *Philosophy of Language and Mind Network Conference* (Spain) *& European Society for Philosophy and Psychology Meeting* (NL)

2025 Act and Speech Act, *French Society for Analytic Philosophy Congress* (France)

2024 Knowledge-First Mindreading and Epistemology, *Joint Session of the Aristotelian Society and the Mind Association Open Session* (UK)

A Non-Ideal Theory of Speech Acts, *Genre and Conversation Workshop* (Iceland) *& Interpretivism, Mental Fictionalism, and Folk Psychology Workshop* (Estonia)

2022 Updates Beyond Semantics and Pragmatics, *Context, Cognition, and Communication Conference* (Poland)

2021 Joint Attention: The Window Into Other Minds?, *APA Pacific Symposium Session* (USA)

Joint Attention and Communication, *Mutual Knowledge 40 Workshop* (UK)

A Puzzle About Demonstrative Understanding, *The Seventh International Conference on Philosophy of Language and Linguistics* (Poland)

2020 The Grammar of Reference, *New York Philosophy of Language Workshop* (USA)

Perspectives in Demonstrative Semantics, *Szklarska Poreba Workshop* (Poland)

2019 Clearing up Clouds, *APA Pacific Colloquium Session* (USA)

2018 Clearing up Clouds, *Context, Cognition, and Communication Conference* (Poland)

2017 Inferences and Neutrality of the Deliberative Ought, *APA Pacific Colloquium Session* (USA) *& Canadian Philosophical Association Meeting* (Canada)

Teaching

Courses Taught as Instructor with Sole Responsibility at the University of Toronto

2023 PHLA10: Reason and Truth (*1st year*)

PHLB58: Reasoning under Uncertainty (*2nd year*)

PHLD87: Advanced Seminar in Philosophy of Mind: Perception and Conception (*4th year*)

2022 PHLC95: Topics in the Philosophy of Mind: Animal Minds (*3rd year*)

PHL100: Introduction to Philosophy: Historical (*1st year*)

2020 PHL390: Special Topics in Philosophy: Frege's Puzzle (*3rd year, online*)

2019 PHL340: Issues in Philosophy of Mind: Perception and Conception (*3rd year*)

Courses Taught as Instructor with Sole Responsibility at Rutgers University

2020 PHL109: Introduction to Formal Reasoning and Decision Making (*1st year, online*)

2019 PHL109: Introduction to Formal Reasoning and Decision Making (*1st year*)

Tutorial Teaching & Grading at the University of Toronto

2013–2021 PHL200: Ancient Philosophy (*2nd year*), PHL210: 17th- and 18th-Century Philosophy (*2nd year*), PHL232: Knowledge and Reality (*2nd year*), PHL100: Introduction to Philosophy (*1st year*), PHL245: Introduction to Symbolic Logic (*2nd year, online*), PHL246: Probability and Inductive Logic (*2nd year*)

Other

2021–2022 Super-TA for the Socrates Project (*Supervising Undergraduate TAs, University of Toronto*)

2016–2018 Philosophy Don (*Tutor and Residence Assistant, Trinity College, University of Toronto*)

Grants

2023–2025 IRC Postdoctoral Fellowship (€105,604)
Awarded annually, by the government of Ireland, to about 12% of applicants.

2016–2019 SSHRC Joseph-Armand Bombardier Doctoral Scholarship ($105,000CAD)
Awarded annually, by the government of Canada, to about 22% of applicants.

Service

2026 Assistant Editor of the Mental Files PhilPapers category
Internal Reviewer of Master's theses for the ENS Department of Cognitive Science

2025 Chair at APA Eastern and International Social Ontology Society Conference

2024 Co-organizer of two philosophy of language workshops at University College Dublin

2023 Commentator at APA Eastern and Canadian Philosophical Association Annual Meeting
Judge at Ontario High School Ethics Bowl

2022 Chair at APA Pacific

2020 Graduate Student Coordinator for an institutional strategic initiative in language and cognition at University of Toronto

Refereeing *The Journal of Philosophy, Philosophical Studies, Synthese, Philosophers' Imprint, Canadian Journal of Philosophy, Erkenntnis, Journal of the American Philosophical Association, Topoi, Philosophical Explorations, Czech Academy of Sciences*

References

Research Imogen Dickie, Professor, Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto
Contact: Imogen.Dickie@utoronto.ca
Nate Charlow, Associate Professor, Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto
Contact: Nate.Charlow@utoronto.ca
Elmar Unnsteinsson, Assistant Professor, School of Philosophy, University College Dublin
Contact: Elmar.Unnsteinsson@ucd.ie
François Recanati, Chair of Philosophy of Language and Mind, Collège de France
Contact francois.recanati@college-de-france.fr

Teaching Rachel Barney, Professor, Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto
Contact: Rachel.Barney@utoronto.ca